COMP3007
HCI, Usability, and Visualisation

20 CREDIT MODULE

ASSESSMENT: 100% Coursework **W1: 30% Report Outline**
W2: 70% Report

MODULE LEADER: Dr Haoyi Wang
MODULE STAFF: Dr Muhammad Asad

MODULE AIMS

- To develop an awareness of good practice in HCI.
- To create appropriate plans for evaluating the usability of software.
- To introduce students to the concepts and techniques of 'Information Visualisation' and highlight it as an application area of HCI principles.

ASSESSED LEARNING OUTCOMES (ALO):

1. Critically evaluate the usability of a small software system and document the user feedback gathered.
2. Redesign the front-end of a small software system in line with good practice in HCI based on user feedback and core HCI principles.
3. Apply the techniques of 'Information Visualisation' and/or devise own techniques to the analysis of data.

Overview

This document contains all the necessary information pertaining to the assessment of *COMP3007 HCI, Usability, and Visualisation*. The module is assessed via **100% coursework**, across two elements: *30% Set Exercises* and *70% Report*.

The sections that follow will detail the assessment tasks that are to be undertaken. The submission and expected feedback dates are presented in Table 1. All assessments are to be submitted electronically via the respective DLE module pages before the stated deadlines.

	Submission Deadline	Feedback
Report Outline (30%)	**3rd March 2026 (15:00)**	**31st March 2026 (15:00)**
Report (70%)	**5th May 2026 (15:00)**	**2nd June 2026 (15:00)**

Table 1: Assessment Deadlines

All assessments will be introduced in class to provide further clarity over what is expected and how you can access support and formative feedback prior to submission. **Whilst the assessment information is provided at the start of the module, it is not necessarily expected you will start this immediately** – as you will often not have sufficient understanding of the topic. The module leader will provide guidance in this respect.

Moderation

This assignment brief has been moderated in line with the university policy.

Moderator Name	Moderation Date
Muhammad Asad	30th January 2026

Table 2: Moderation Record

Useful Assignment Information

Please see below some useful information regarding submissions for your modules.

Good Coding Practices

Like all things, no code is perfect. Just because your code compiles and runs does not mean it is perfect, there is always room for improvement. No code will achieve 100% of the available marks. Where code submission is required by a module, it will be assessed against the following criteria:

1) **Functionality**
    a. Does your code meet all the specified requirements of the assignment?
    b. Does your code behave correctly across typical and edge-case scenarios?
    c. Does you code have appropriate error handling that does not leading to it crashing or undefined behaviour?
2) **Efficiency**
    a. Is your code optimised in terms of performance and resource use?
    b. Does you code handle functions, variables, data calls efficiently?
    c. Is there any unnecessary repetition, complexity or processing reducing efficiency within your code?
3) **Readability**
    a. Is your code logically structured and easy to read?
    b. Have you maintained standard formatting conventions like indentations, spacing and naming, within your code?
    c. Are variables, functions, and classes clearly named and purposeful?
4) **Documentation**
    a. Are there helpful comments explaining non-obvious parts of your code?
    b. Do your comments document your process, development or rationale clearly?
    c. Could someone unfamiliar with the code understand the approach you have taken?

Use of Generative AI for Creating Code

Each assignment element for each module will have a clear indication of the permitted level of use of AI (solo, assisted or partnered) including the generation of code. Please ensure that you **read and understand the permitted use**. If you are unsure of a particular use, please reach out to the Module Leader and ask.

We strongly encourage you to read and explore beyond the core content delivered within the modules. However, this must be done correctly following academic process. Wherever code is drawn from an outside source (e.g. you have not written it yourself), regardless of whether this is AI generated or from an online repository (GitHub, Stack Overflow etc) **you must reference the original source**. This can be done in your documentation as comments or part of your write ups. Students found to be utilising code without referencing could face an academic offence. **If in doubt speak to your Module Leader.**

Versioning

A critical part of a development (software or academic) is versioning. Keeping a number of iterations over the course of development ensures you always have backups to fall back on. It also provides clear demonstration of the development process you implemented.

Using online/cloud-based storage solutions and repositories provide additional peace of mind, alongside being industry practice. The university provide OneDrive to all students which offers inbuilt version history for Microsoft products. GitHub is the university recommended repository for versioning code, which includes great integration with a number of IDEs.

Submitting Code

It is vital that you confirm that all code that you submit is in the **correct format** and **compiles correctly** or **runs without error**. If you clean up your code before submission, please ensure that all dependencies (libraries, functions and variables) are included so that the marker can compile your code.

We can only mark what has been submitted. If the code does not run correctly, it is not our responsibility to spend time error handling to award you marks.

It is also important to **show your working**. Tidying up your code is a critical part of coding practices, but if you remove the workings that provides you with the required output, we cannot see how you got there.

In a worst-case scenario, if you remove a key part of your working, and on compiling your code it gives an error or different result, we have no way of confirming what went wrong, or indeed if you fabricated those outputs.

Please note, just because a piece of code has given the wrong output, it does not mean it should be deleted. Seeing these attempts with comments documenting your attempt allows us to understand where you may have made an error and provide feedback that addresses this. In some cases, you could also be awarded marks for the attempt.

Assessment 1: Set Exercises

Task:

You are required to conduct a user experience (UX) evaluation by completing the following six Set Exercises:

1. Select a piece of software/website to evaluate during these Set Exercises. This must be unique, not the same as anybody else in the class.
    - To register the software/website you have chosen, please go to Software website dataset selection.xlsx.

2. Plan a UX evaluation of this software/website. Gather up your documentation to ensure you are (and that you can evidence you are) working with human participants ethically. You will need all of the following:
    - University of Plymouth Ethics Approval
    - Research Information Sheet
    - Participant Right to Withdraw slip
    - Ethics Consent Form
    - Task scenarios – the list of tasks you will ask the participant to do
    - Exit questionnaire – why the participant wants to quit your study, any reasons

    You will need to design the task scenarios and exit questionnaires based on the software/website you have chosen. We will provide the rest of the documents for you on DLE.

3. Carry out a "mock" evaluation with one of your peers.
    - This is essential professional practice as it identifies whether you have any issues in your planning or documentation.
    - Make any corrections or changes to your evaluation process as needed.

4. Now you are ready to start by recruiting your 7+ participants.
    - Note that the ethical approval covers you to use other Plymouth University students as well as family and/or friends.
    - Note that everyone you test must be over 18 years old.

5. Run your usability evaluations with your 7+ participants.
    - There may be time to do some evaluations during our labs.

6. Create a 6-minute video submission as specified below:
    - Your video will be the main submission for the first assessment. It is your responsibility to ensure it is complete.
    - Your video will be paused for thorough reading.
    - Do not simply read your slides.
    - Marking will end at 6:00 exactly.

Submission Requirements:

- Your video must be made available via YouTube. It should meet the following quality criteria:
    - Strictly follow the content structure given below so you do not incur any penalties.

- The video length should not be more than 6 minutes. You must not speed up your video to gain more time. Marking will stop at exactly 6:00. No exceptions. Note, last year, some students scored lost marks because their videos went beyond the cut-off. Therefore, they got no marks for all the ideas they presented after that point.
- The video resolution should be at least 720p, ideally 1080p.
- Show only the slides, not you, on your webcam.
- Please remember to narrate what you are showing; it is not supposed to be a silent movie. Also, please do not read your slides. Just explain what it is you are showing on the current screen.
- Use the free software like OBS Studio (https://obsproject.com/) if you do not have any that is appropriate.

- A single PDF document to DLE that contains:
  1. The link to your YouTube video.
  2. Completed Generative AI Declaration.

Video Structure:

The structure and order of content in your video are extremely important. Your video MUST be structured as specified in the following table. Please be very careful and pay close attention to these instructions. We want you to score as many as possible.

Content	Details
Section 1	Clearly mark the start of the section with an appropriate title

Present the software you selected and describe your evaluation.	• Use around 1 minute for this section
	• Explain what we need to know about this software/website. What was it purpose? Explain your evaluation; the process you went through, about your participants etc. What did you actually do?
	• At the end of this section, you must show the below documents for 8-10 seconds in total (and in this order to avoid penalty). We will pause the video to read each one.
	  ○ University of Plymouth Ethics Approval
	  ○ Research Information Sheet
	  ○ Participant Right to Withdraw slip
	  ○ Ethics Consent Form
	  ○ Task scenarios
	  ○ Exit questionnaire

Section 2	Clearly mark the start of the section with an appropriate title
Describe your analysis and redesign process.	• Use around 1.5 minutes for this section. • How did you collect data, what did you do with the data you collected? How did you go from data to decision making/deciding? What to change and how to change it? • Ensure all text is big enough to read. • Finish this section by presenting an overview of all the issues you identified in your data analysis. Group them into two lists, essential and desirable, and priorities the items in each list.

Section 3	Clearly mark the start of the section with an appropriate title

Communicate (using any means) how you would change the front-end of the software/website to overcome each of the issues you identified.	• Use around 3.5 minutes for this section.
	• Use it to explain/demonstrate how you would redesign your software/website to overcome the issues you identified in your study.
	• For each redesign idea:
	  ○ Show a clear screenshot of the software/website before.
	  ○ Show a clear screenshot of the software/website after. For example, you could use Microsoft PowerPoint starting with the original screenshot and then overlay your ideas on top.
	  ○ On both screenshots highlight the area of the screen you are describing. For example, you could draw a rectangle around that specific area of the screenshot.
	  ○ Show any number of redesigns in the time you have left. You can use the same before and after screenshot to highlight several different areas that you would redesign.

Table 3. Precise structure of your video

Acceptable level of generative AI tool use in this assessment element

The acceptable level of GenAI use for this element is detailed with the allowed uses listed below. This is split into three categories (**Solo Work** – work must be your own with no AI support, **Assisted Work** – some uses of AI tools allowed, **Partnered Work** – AI tools integral part of the work). If you have any questions, please contact the module leader.

Solo Work	You must not use generative AI tools.	☒
Assisted Work	You are permitted to use generative AI tools in an assistive role.	☐
Partnered Work	Generative AI tool use is required as an integral part of the assessment, but transparency is required.	☐

Table 4. Acceptable Level of generative AI use

Inline with the indicated acceptable level of AI use above, the following uses are acceptable:

- **S1 - Generative AI tools have not been used for this assessment.**

Any use of AI in your work must be declared within your documentation. You **must also include a signed Generative AI Declaration as an appendix to your submission**. The declaration form can be found on the module's DLE page (in the Assessments section).

Assessment Criteria:

The following marking scheme will be used for this part of the assessment:

- Video – Section 1 (20%)
- Video – Section 2 (30%)
- Video – Section 3 (40%)
- Overall Presentation (10%)

An illustration of the feedback template is presented in Table 5.

Threshold Criteria (these are indicative only):

Criteria	Fail (<40%)	3rd (40%+)	2:2 (50%+)	2:1 (60%+)	1st (70%+)	Grade
Video – Section 1: Present the software you selected and describe your evaluation	No software/website selected, OR no video for this section, OR no evaluation conducted, OR fewer than 4 required documents shown.	Software/website has identifiable UX elements to evaluate (e.g., forms navigation, workflows.) Basic description of software/website purpose provided. Evaluation conducted with 7+ participants. All required documents displayed in correct order.	Clear explanation of software/website purpose and intended users. Evaluation methodology briefly explained. Participant count and basic demographics mentioned.	Detailed software/website context including target users, key features, and why it was selected. Evaluation methodology explained with rationale. Participant recruitment strategy and demographics clearly described.	Comprehensive software/website analysis including competitive context or market position. Rigorous evaluation design with clear justification for chosen methods. Detailed participant profiles demonstrating diverse, representative sample.	**/20**
Video – Section 2: Describe your analysis and redesign process	No analysis presented, OR no redesign process described, OR video for this section does not exist or play.	Data collection method stated. 3-4 usability issues identified from user feedback. Issues listed but categorisation into essential/desirable may be incomplete or unclear.	Data collection and basic analysis approach explained (e.g., how feedback was synthesised). 5-6 usability issues identified with brief supporting evidence. Issues grouped into essential and desirable categories with basic prioritisation.	Clear data-to-decision pathway demonstrated (showing how raw data led to identified issues). 7-8 usability issue identified with specific evidence from participants. Well-prioritised lists with rationale for ordering.	Systematic analysis methodology with clear evidence trail (e.g., affinity mapping, severity ratings). 9+ usability issues identified with direct quotes or specific behavioural observations. Comprehensive prioritisation using established criteria (e.g., frequency, impact, feasibility).	**/30**
Video – Section 3: Communicate how you would change the software/website to overcome each of the issues you identified	No redesign proposals presented, OR video for this section was not submitted or does not play.	2-3 redesign proposals shown. Before/after screenshots present with changed areas highlighted (e.g., rectangles). Basic explanation of what was changed, though connection to identified issues may be implicit.	3-4 redesign proposals shown. Clear visual highlighting of modified areas on both before and after screenshots. Explanations link each redesign to specific issues identified in Section 2.	4-5 redesign proposals shown. Clear before/after comparisons with professional highlighting. Good explanations connecting user feedback to design decisions, referencing HCI principles where appropriate.	6+ redesign proposals shown. Professional-quality mockups with clear visual hierarchy. Comprehensive explanations demonstrating deep understanding of HCI principles. Redesigns address both essential and desirable issues.	**/40**
Overall Presentation	Video not accessible (private/broken link), OR wrong format, OR exceeds 6:00, OR missing AI Declaration, OR video is sped up to fit time limit.	Video accessible on YouTube at minimum 720p. Three sections clearly labelled. Narration present throughout. AI Declaration included in submission PDF. Video ends by 6:00.	Clear transitions between sections. Narration explains content rather than reading slides verbatim. Good audio quality (clear speech, minimal background noise). Text on screen is legible.	Professional pacing with appropriate time allocation per section (~1 min, ~1.5 min, ~3.5 min). Engaging narration that adds insight beyond visual content. Clear visual hierarchy in all slides.	Excellent production quality (1080p, professional audio). Compelling narrative flow that tells a coherent story. All technical requirements met with margin. Demonstrates strong presentation skills.	**/10**
Feedback/Overall	*Additional feedback*					**/100**

Table 5. Feedback Template for Assessment 1

Assessment 2: Report

Task:

You are now required to put everything you have learned in the module into practice. You will select a publicly available dataset, research it in detail, and then propose your own ideas for its information visualisation. To do this, you will need to complete the activities specified in the remainder of this section. Once completed, you need to write up your work as a short research paper to submit it.

1. Select your dataset

The first thing you need to do is select your dataset. Again, to do so, please open Software website dataset selection.xlsx. Your dataset must be unique, not the same as anybody else in the class.

Your data must be selected from a site written in English. You will use this dataset throughout the entire report, so take your time and ensure you do this crucial task well. Having said that, some of you may need to set a deadline for yourselves so that you don't procrastinate unduly. There are many, many sites where you can get access to publicly available datasets.

Here are a few to get you started:

- Dataquest, '43 Free Datasets for Projects: Building an Irresistible Portfolio', viewed 29/01/26, 43 Free Datasets for Projects: Building an Irresistible Portfolio
- Kaggle, 'Datasets', viewed 29/01/26, Search | Kaggle
- Tableau, 'Free Public Data Sets for Analysis', viewed 29/01/26, Free Public Data Sets For Analysis | Tableau

Have a look; there is data on almost everything. This is something you can do right now, at the very start of the module.

During one of your lab sessions, you are strongly advised to show the lab demonstrator your dataset to ensure that it is appropriate. We recommend that the dataset have a minimum of 20 unique variables (columns in the spreadsheet) and over 1000 instances of data (rows in the spreadsheet).

- Note that columns need to be unique so that the data is genuinely multivariate (has enough depth for you to do your work).
- For example, the columns Pressure, Volume, Temperature, Density and Viscosity are examples of variables that are unique.
- For example, the columns Week 1, Week 2, Week 3, and Week 4 are an example of variables that are NOT unique.

Our top tip for this coursework is to start early, take your time on this step, and select a dataset that will provide you with lots of scope; the more, the better! As with all research, novelty can create a significant impact.

2. Research the current state-of-the-art for your dataset

The next step is to carry out some in-depth research into what good ideas and solutions are already available for the information visualisation of your selected dataset. You should "cast your net wide…" for this part of the process. Look at past successes as well as new cutting-edge innovations.

Tip: If your dataset is about football statistics, you should start by researching the current state-of-the-art for football data. But do not just research football; research other sports, such as rugby and cricket, to gain as much insight into other ways to visualise your dataset.

3. Derive your own innovation (come up with your own innovative ideas)

The next part of the process is sometimes the most challenging yet always the most interesting part. This is a core reference to help get you started: *Shneiderman, B. (1996). 'The eyes have it: a task by data type taxonomy for information visualization,' Proceedings of IEEE Workshop on Visual Languages, IEEE Computer Society Press: Washington. 336-343.*

By this stage, you will know your dataset in depth. You will also have a thorough understanding of current methods used to visualise this information. So, now it's your turn to propose your own ground-breaking ideas for the information visualisation of your chosen dataset!

It is satisfactory if you solely want to propose the novel application of relevant information visualisation techniques to your dataset. It would be far superior if you derived novel, creative techniques of your own. Given all that you now know about your data and how it is currently visualised, what would you do next? What do you want to see? Where would you go next?

4. Prototype your ideas

It is entirely up to you how you present your innovative information visualisation ideas for evaluation. You can use any approach you prefer for this task, such as coding or using visualisation tools. The focus here is on your research, the insight you gained, and the new ideas you are suggesting.

5. Evaluate your ideas

It is impossible for researchers to publish research in this applied area of computing without evaluation. Therefore, you are also required to carry out an evaluation of your ideas. It is entirely up to you how you evaluate your ideas. Refer to all the different techniques for evaluation taught in the module and select the most appropriate method for your investigation.

Submission Requirements:

- A single PDF document to DLE.
- The report should be 4-5 pages long, including figures, diagrams, tables, and references.
- The report should follow the structure outlined below.
- Appendix with completed Generative AI Declaration.

Report Structure

Start your paper by introducing it and putting a nomenclature if necessary. The paragraphs continue from there and are only separated by headings, subheadings, images, and formulae. The section headings are arranged by numbers, bold and 14 pt. for main sections and 12 pt. for subsections.

Here is a report structure that you could use:

- Introduction
- Description of data selected.

- Current state-of-the-art
- Your ideas/contributions to the field
- Evaluation of your ideas/contributions to the field
- Conclusions
- References

Please download and use the "Report Templete.docx" file from the DLE. It is an example document we have uploaded to the DLE, which is already formatted.

Your report should be created in Microsoft Word only and should be formatted for submission using this Microsoft Word style document. Figures and tables should be embedded and not supplied separately. Please make sure that you use (as much as possible) normal fonts in your documents. To avoid errors, you are strongly advised to use the 'spellchecker' function of Microsoft Word.

Follow this order when typing manuscripts: Title, Authors, Affiliations, Main text (including figures and tables), and References. Bulleted lists may be included and should look like this:

- First point
- Second point
- And so on

Introduction: An Introduction summarises, usually in one paragraph of 300 words or less, the major aspects of the entire paper in a prescribed sequence that includes: a) the overall purpose of the study and the research problem(s) you investigated; b) the basic design of the study; c) major findings or trends found as a result of your analysis; and d) a brief summary of your interpretations and conclusions.

Tables: All tables should be numbered with Arabic numerals. Every table should have a caption. Headings should be placed above tables, left justified. Only horizontal lines should be used within a table, to distinguish the column headings from the body of the table, and immediately above and below the table. Tables must be embedded into the text and not supplied separately.

Construction of references: References must be listed at the end of the paper. Do not begin them on a new page unless this is absolutely necessary. Authors should ensure that every reference in the text appears in the list of references and vice versa. Indicate references by [1,2] or [1] in the text. Some examples of how your references should be listed are given at the end of this template in the 'References' section, which will allow you to assemble your reference list according to the correct format and font size.

Section headings: Section headings should be left justified, bold, with the first letter capitalised and numbered consecutively, starting with the Introduction. Sub-section headings should be in capital and lower-case italic letters, numbered 1.1, 1.2, etc., and left justified, with second and subsequent lines indented. All headings should have a minimum of three text lines after them before a page or column break. Ensure the text area is not blank except for the last page.

General guidelines for the preparation of your text: Avoid hyphenation at the end of a line. Symbols denoting vectors and matrices should be indicated in bold type. Scalar variable names should

normally be expressed using italics. All non-standard abbreviations or symbols must be defined when first mentioned, or a glossary provided.

References

Note that the University of Plymouth Library has produced an online support referencing guide which is available here: Referencing - Referencing & Plagiarism - Library Guides at University of Plymouth. Another recommended referencing resource is Cite Them Right Online; this is an online resource which provides you with specific guidance about how to reference lots of different types of materials.

Acceptable level of generative AI tool use in this assessment element

The acceptable level of GenAI use for this element is detailed with the allowed uses listed below. This is split into three categories (**Solo Work** – work must be your own with no AI support, **Assisted Work** – some uses of AI tools allowed, **Partnered Work** – AI tools integral part of the work). If you have any questions, please contact the module leader.

Solo Work	You must not use generative AI tools.	☐
Assisted Work	You are permitted to use generative AI tools in an assistive role.	☒
Partnered Work	Generative AI tool use is required as an integral part of the assessment, but transparency is required.	☐

Table 6: Acceptable Level of generative AI use

Inline with the indicated acceptable level of AI use above, the following uses are acceptable:

- **A4 - Research Assistance**
- **A5 - Language Refinement**

Any use of AI in your work must be declared within your documentation. You **must also include a signed Generative AI Declaration as an appendix to your submission**. The declaration form can be found on the module's DLE page (in the Assessments section).

Assessment Criteria:

The following marking scheme will be used for this part of the assessment:

- Introduction (10%)
- Description of data selected (10%)
- Current state-of-the-art (15%)
- Your ideas/contributions to the field (30%)
- Evaluation of your ideas/contributions to the field (15%)
- Conclusions (10%)
- References & Presentation (10%)

An illustration of the feedback template is presented in Table 7.

Criteria	Fail (<40%)	3rd (40%+)	2:2 (50%+)	2:1 (60%+)	1st (70%+)	Grade
Introduction	No introduction, OR introduction does not describe the research problem, study purpose, or report structure. Missing or irrelevant content.	Introduction present with basic description of: (a) research problem/dataset topic, (b) purpose of the study, and (c) report structure. May lack clarity or coherence in places.	Clear introduction covering all required elements: research problem, study purpose, methodology overview, and report structure. Logical flow between elements.	Well-written introduction that clearly articulates: the significance of the chosen dataset, specific research questions, methodology rationale, and key findings preview.	Excellent introduction that compellingly establishes: the importance and novelty of the research, clear research questions with justification, methodology overview, and a concise summary of key contributions. Publication-ready quality.	**/10**
Description of data selected	No dataset description, OR dataset does not meet minimum requirements (fewer than 20 unique variables or fewer than 1000 instances).	Dataset meets minimum requirements (20+ unique variables, 1000+ instances). Basic description of: data source, number of variables and instances, and general topic area.	Clear dataset description including: source with URL/citation, detailed variable list with data types, instance count, and explanation of why the dataset is suitable for information visualisation.	Comprehensive dataset analysis including: provenance and credibility of source, detailed variable descriptions with examples, data quality assessment, and clear justification for selection based on visualisation potential.	Excellent dataset documentation including: authoritative source verification, complete data dictionary with variable relationships, quality/completeness analysis, and compelling argument for why this dataset offers rich visualisation opportunities.	**/10**
Current state-of-the-art	No literature review, OR sources not relevant to information visualisation or the dataset domain.	1-2 relevant sources cited covering: existing visualisation techniques for similar data, and/or visualisation tools used in the domain. Basic summary of each source provided.	2-3 relevant sources including mix of: academic papers, industry examples, and visualisation tools. Clear explanation of how existing techniques relate to the chosen dataset. Some critical analysis of strengths/limitations.	2-3 sources with good breadth (academic, industry, tools) and depth. Critical comparison of visualisation approaches. Clear identification of gaps in current solutions that justify proposed innovations.	3+ high-quality sources including seminal works, recent innovations, and domain-specific examples. Systematic critical analysis identifying specific opportunities for novel contribution.	**/15**
Your ideas/contributions to the field	No visualisation ideas presented, OR no prototypes/mockups provided.	1-2 visualisation ideas presented with basic prototypes/mockups. Ideas apply existing techniques to the dataset. Connection to identified issues from state-of-the-art review is implicit.	2-3 visualisation ideas with clear prototypes. At least one idea shows adaptation or combination of existing techniques. Clear explanation of how each visualisation addresses specific data characteristics or user needs.	4-5 visualisation ideas including at least one novel technique or significant innovation. High-quality prototypes demonstrating implementation feasibility. Strong justification linking each idea to literature gaps and dataset characteristics.	5+ visualisation ideas including multiple novel contributions. Professional-quality interactive prototypes or detailed mockups. Ideas demonstrate deep understanding of HCI and visualisation principles. Clear potential for real-world impact.	**/30**
Evaluation of your ideas/contributions to the field	No evaluation conducted, OR evaluation method inappropriate or not described.	Basic evaluation conducted using one method. Method described but limited in rigour. Some reflection on results provided.	Evaluation using appropriate method taught in module. Method clearly described with rationale. Results presented with reflection on strengths and weaknesses of proposed visualisations.	Rigorous evaluation using 1-2 appropriate methods with clear methodology. Participant details provided if applicable. Systematic presentation of results. Thoughtful discussion of limitations and future improvements.	Comprehensive evaluation using multiple complementary methods. Professional methodology with appropriate sample size or expert reviewers. Statistical or systematic analysis of results. Critical reflection leading to concrete design recommendations.	**/15**
Conclusions	No conclusion, OR conclusion does not relate to the work presented, OR simply repeats the introduction.	Basic conclusion summarising: what was done, key findings from evaluation. May lack reflection on contributions or future work.	Clear conclusion covering: summary of contributions, key evaluation findings, limitations acknowledged, and brief suggestions for future work.	Well-structured conclusion with: clear articulation of contributions to information visualisation field, honest assessment of limitations, and specific actionable recommendations for future research.	Excellent conclusion that: synthesises contributions in context of literature review, provides nuanced reflection on evaluation findings, acknowledges limitations with mitigation strategies, and outlines compelling future research directions with potential impact.	**/10**

References & Presentation	References not properly formatted, OR report exceeds 5 pages, OR does not use required template, OR missing AI Declaration.	References in consistent format. Report uses required template. 4-5 pages. Basic formatting (numbered sections, embedded figures). AI Declaration included. Some minor formatting inconsistencies.	Professional presentation with clear section structure, properly captioned figures and tables. Good use of visual elements to support text. No major formatting errors.	Good number of references including peer-reviewed sources. Excellent presentation with professional figures, consistent formatting throughout. Effective use of white space and visual hierarchy. All figures/tables referenced in text.	High-quality references predominantly from peer-reviewed venues. Publication-ready presentation matching professional conference/journal standards. Exceptional visual design with informative, well-designed figures that enhance understanding.	**/10**
Feedback/Overall	*Additional feedback*					**/100**

Table 7: Feedback Template for Assessment 2

Acceptable levels of AI use:

The table below provides the acceptable use categories for GenAI. Each assessment element may allow different uses. Please check the brief for each element carefully to see what uses are allowed.

Solo Work	**S1 - Generative AI tools have not been used for this assessment.**
Assisted Work	**A1 – Idea Generation and Problem Exploration** Used to generate project ideas, explore different approaches to solving a problem, or suggest features for software or systems. Students must critically assess AI-generated suggestions and ensure their own intellectual contributions are central.
	A2 - Planning & Structuring Projects AI may help outline the structure of reports, documentation and projects. The final structure and implementation must be the student's own work.
	A3 – Code Architecture AI tools maybe used to help outline code architecture (e.g. suggesting class hierarchies or module breakdowns). The final code structure must be the student's own work.
	A4 – Research Assistance Used to locate and summarise relevant articles, academic papers, technical documentation, or online resources (e.g. Stack Overflow, GitHub discussions. The interpretation and integration of research into the assignment remain the student's responsibility.
	A5 - Language Refinement Used to check grammar, refine language, improve sentence structure in documentation not code. AI should be used only to provide suggestions for improvement. Students must ensure that the documentation accurately reflects the code and is technically correct.
	A6 – Code Review AI tools can be used to check comments within the code and to suggest improvements to code readability, structure or syntax. AI should be used only to provide suggestions for improvement. Students must ensure that the code accurately reflects their knowledge and is technically correct.
	A7 - Code Generation for Learning Purposes Used to generate example code snippets to understand syntax, explore alternative implementations, or learn new programming paradigms. Students must not submit AI-generated code as their own and must be able to explain how it works.
	A8 - Technical Guidance & Debugging Support AI tools can be used to explain algorithms, programming concepts, or debugging strategies. Students may also help interpret error messages or suggest possible fixes. However, students must write, test, and debug their own code independently and understand all solutions submitted.
	A9 - Testing and Validation Support AI may assist in generating test cases, validating outputs, or suggesting edge cases for software testing. Students are responsible for designing comprehensive test plans and interpreting test results.
	A10 - Data Analysis and Visualization Guidance AI tools can help suggest ways to analyse datasets or visualize results (e.g. recommending chart types or statistical methods). Students must perform the analysis themselves and understand the implications of the results.
	A11 - Other uses not listed above Please specify:
Partnered Work	**P1 - Generative AI tool usage has been used integrally for this assessment** Students can adopt approaches that are compliant with instructions in the assessment brief. Please Specify:

General Guidance

Extenuating Circumstances

There may be a time during this module where you experience a serious situation which has a significant impact on your ability to complete the assessments. The definition of these can be found in the University Policy on Extenuating Circumstances here:
https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/exams/exam-rules-and-regulations/extenuating-circumstances

Plagiarism

All of your work must be of your own words. You must use references for your sources, however you acquire them. Where you wish to use quotations, these must be a very minor part of your overall work.

To copy another person's work is viewed as plagiarism and is not allowed. Any issues of plagiarism and any form of academic dishonesty are treated very seriously. All your work must be your own and other sources must be identified as being theirs, not yours. The copying of another persons' work could result in a penalty being invoked.

Further information on plagiarism policy can be found here:

Plagiarism: https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/regulations/plagiarism

Examination Offences: https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/exams/exam-rules-and-regulations/examination-offences

Turnitin (http://www.turnitinuk.com/) is an Internet-based 'originality checking tool' which allows documents to be compared with content on the Internet, in journals and in an archive of previously submitted works. It can help to detect unintentional or deliberate plagiarism.

It is a formative tool that makes it easy for students to review their citations and referencing as an aid to learning good academic practice. Turnitin produces an 'originality report' to help guide you. To learn more about Turnitin go to:
https://help.turnitin.com/new-links.htm?Highlight=guide

The university also had Draft Coach available on the online version of Microsoft Word. Draft Coach is a Turnitin plugin and provides instant feedback on how to address citation issues, grammar mistakes and matches with Turnitin's database.

Referencing

The University of Plymouth Library has produced an online support referencing guide which is available here: http://plymouth.libguides.com/referencing.

Another recommended referencing resource is Cite Them Right Online; this is an online resource which provides you with specific guidance about how to reference lots of different types of materials.